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INFORMATION PROCESSING SYSTEM, INFORMATION PROCESSING METHOD AND STORAGE MEDIUM

Abstract

Setting or verification of a monitoring rule in response to a monitoring target environment is supported. An information processing system includes a situation information receiving unit that receives an input of situation information indicating a situation in a monitoring target environment. The information processing system further includes a normal situation storage unit. The normal situation storage unit stores environment information indicating the monitoring target environment in association with a set of situation information indicating a situation that is not abnormal in the monitoring target environment. The information processing system further includes a retrieval unit. The retrieval unit refers to the normal situation storage unit upon receiving the input of the situation information indicating the information in the monitoring target environment. The retrieval unit then retrieves the environment information associated with the set of the situation information that does not include the input situation information.

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Background/Summary

METHOD AND STORAGE MEDIUM [0001] The present application is a Continuation Application of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 18/232,746 filed on Aug. 10, 2023, which is a Continuation Application of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 18/197,972 filed on May 16, 2023, which issued as U.S. Pat. No. 12,066,994, which is a Continuation Application of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/241,185 filed on Apr. 27, 2021, which issued as U.S. Pat. No. 11,693,838, which is a Continuation Application of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/711,584 filed on Dec. 12, 2019, which issued as U.S. Pat. No. 11,023,436, which is a Continuation Application of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/266,281 filed on Feb. 4, 2019, which issued as U.S. Pat. No. 10,552,395, which is a Continuation Application of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 14/782,428 filed on Oct. 5, 2015, which issued as U.S. Pat. No. 10,346,377, which is a National Stage Entry of international application PCT/JP2014/002131, filed on Apr. 15, 2014, which claims the benefit of priority from Japanese Patent Application 2013-090536 filed on Apr. 23, 2013, the disclosures of all of which are incorporated herein, in their entirety, by this reference.

TECHNICAL FIELD

[0002] The present invention relates to an information processing system and the like.

BACKGROUND ART

[0003] Monitoring system is a system intended to improve security at a station, an airport, or the like. The monitoring system is configured to include a sensor such as a camera and a microphone. The monitoring system monitors occurrence of an abnormal condition by using a sensor output and a monitoring rule. The monitoring rule is a conditional expression representing what value of the sensor output causes a determination of occurrence of an abnormal condition.

[0004] For example, the monitoring rule is a conditional expression such as “if a camera takes an image of a person putting down luggage, nobody comes close to the luggage for a predetermined

time, then issue a warning”. When the conditional clause of this monitoring rule is satisfied, it can be interpreted that an abnormal condition of “luggage abandonment” is occurring, for example. [0005] PTL 1 discloses a monitoring system that monitors occurrence of an abnormal condition by using a sensor output and a monitoring rule. PTL 1 discloses that occurrence of an abnormal condition is detected at a plurality of different places. PTL 1 discloses that monitoring rules to be set are different between a case of monitoring a store which manages merchandise by a Point Of Sale system (POS) and a case of monitoring a store which manages merchandise by a Radio Frequency IDentification (RFID) tag.

[0006] PTL 2 discloses a technique of automatically generating a monitoring rule based on a database in which data concerning abnormal events are registered and a database in which data concerning normal events are registered.

CITATION LIST

Patent Literature

[0007] [PTL 1] Japanese Translation of PCT International Application Publication No. 2009-539182 [0008] [PTL 2] Japanese Laid-open Patent Publication No. 2013-003929

SUMMARY OF INVENTION

Technical Problem

[0009] PTL 1 discloses that different monitoring rules are set in response to a place to be monitored (hereafter, referred to as “monitoring target place”). According to the technique disclosed in PTL 1, without special knowledge on the monitoring target place, an operator of the monitoring system is unable to set an appropriate monitoring rule. According to the technique disclosed in PTL 2, a monitoring rule in response to an environment to be monitored (hereafter, referred to as “monitoring target environment”) cannot be generated.

[0010] One of the objectives of the present invention is to support setting or verification of a monitoring rule in response to a monitoring target environment.

Solution to Problem

[0011] A first aspect of the present invention is an information processing system including: a situation information receiving unit which receives an input of situation information indicating a situation in a monitoring target environment; a normal situation storage unit which stores environment information indicating the monitoring target environment in association with a set of situation information indicating a situation that is not abnormal in the monitoring target environment; and a retrieval unit which, in response to receiving the input of the situation information indicating the information in the monitoring target environment, refers to the normal situation storage unit and retrieves the environment information associated with the set of the situation information that does not include the input situation information.

[0012] A second aspect of the present invention is an information processing method which is: performed by a computer that can access a normal situation storage unit which stores environment information indicating a monitoring target environment in association with a set of situation information indicating a situation that is not abnormal in the monitoring target information, the set of the situation information being selected out of pieces of situation information indicating a situation in the monitoring target environment. The method includes: receiving an input of the situation information indicating a situation in the monitoring target information; and in response to receiving the input of the situation information, referring to the normal situation storage unit and retrieving environment information associated with a set of the situation information that does not include the input situation information.

[0013] A third aspect of the present invention is a program that causes a computer that can access a normal situation storage unit which stores environment information indicating a monitoring target environment in association with a set of situation information indicating a situation that is not abnormal in the monitoring target information, the set of the situation information being selected out of pieces of situation information indicating a situation in the monitoring target environment, to

execute: a process of receiving an input of the situation information indicating a situation in the monitoring target information; and a process of, in response to receiving the input of the situation information, referring to the normal situation storage unit and retrieving environment information associated with a set of the situation information that does not include the input situation information.

[0014] Further, the objective of the present invention is achieved by a computer readable storage medium in which the program described above is stored.

Advantageous Effects of Invention

[0015] The present invention can support setting or verification of a monitoring rule in response to a monitoring target environment.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF DRAWINGS

[0016] FIG. **1** is a block diagram illustrating a configuration of an information processing system **1000** according to a first exemplary embodiment of the present invention;

[0017] FIG. **2** is an example of information stored by a normal situation storage unit **210** according to the first exemplary embodiment of the present invention;

[0018] FIG. **3** is a diagram illustrating an example of a hardware configuration that can realize the information processing system **1000** of the present invention;

[0019] FIG. **4** is a flowchart illustrating an operation of the information processing system **1000** according to the first exemplary embodiment of the present invention;

[0020] FIG. **5** is a block diagram illustrating a configuration of an information processing system **1000** according to a second exemplary embodiment of the present invention;

[0021] FIG. **6** is a flowchart illustrating an operation of the information processing system **1000** according to the second exemplary embodiment of the present invention;

[0022] FIG. **7** is a block diagram illustrating a configuration of an information processing system **1000** according to a third exemplary embodiment of the present invention;

[0023] FIG. **8** is a flowchart illustrating an operation of the information processing system **1000** according to the third exemplary embodiment of the present invention;

[0024] FIG. **9** is a block diagram illustrating a configuration of an information processing system **1000** according to a fourth exemplary embodiment of the present invention; and

[0025] FIG. **10** is a flowchart illustrating an operation of the information processing system **1000** according to the fourth exemplary embodiment of the present invention.

DESCRIPTION OF EMBODIMENTS

[0026] In order to facilitate the understanding of the invention, the problem to be solved by the present invention will be described in details.

[0027] Monitoring systems can monitor various environments. For example, monitoring systems can monitor various places such as “stadium”, “airport”, or “kitchen”. When monitoring a stadium, a monitoring system can monitor various events such as “soccer game” or “rock live concert”. When monitoring the stadium where a soccer game is held, for example, the monitoring system can perform monitoring in various time slots such as “morning”, “before the game”, “during the game”, “after the game”, or “night”.

[0028] In the followings, “place”, “event”, “time slot”, and the like are collectively described as “environment to be monitored” or “monitoring target environment” Further, information indicating the monitoring target environment is described as “environment information”.

[0029] In order for the monitoring system to perform appropriate monitoring, an operator of the monitoring system is required to set a monitoring rule in response to a monitoring target environment. When the monitoring target environment is a piano concert, for example, it is

appropriate to set a monitoring rule such as “if a person screams loudly, then issue an alarm”. The situation where a person screams loudly at a piano concert is an abnormal situation. When a conditional expression of this monitoring rule is satisfied at a piano concert, it can be interpreted that some abnormal condition is occurring. However, when the monitoring target environment is a rock live concert, it is not appropriate to set the monitoring rule as described above. A situation where a person screams loudly at the rock live concert is not at all the abnormal situation. However, in the monitoring system in which this monitoring rule is set, an alarm is issued for such a usual situation that a person screams loudly.

[0030] In order to set an appropriate monitoring rule in response to a monitoring target environment, the operator of the monitoring system is required to have special knowledge of the monitoring target environment. When the operator without the special knowledge sets a monitoring rule, an inappropriate monitoring rule is likely to be set by which the usual situation for the monitoring target environment can be determined as an abnormal condition.

[0031] Further, setting different monitoring rules for every monitoring target environment is a complicated operation for the operator of the monitoring system. One of the devices for reducing man-hour in setting the monitoring rule is an expansion of a monitoring rule. The expansion of a monitoring rule is to divert a conditional clause of the monitoring rule set for monitoring a certain environment to a conditional clause of the monitoring rule for monitoring another environment. However, when the operator of the monitoring system expands the monitoring rule without paying a special attention, an environment where an inappropriate monitoring rule may be set are likely to occur.

First Exemplary Embodiment

[0032] FIG. 1 is a block diagram illustrating a configuration of an information processing system **1000** according to a first exemplary embodiment. As illustrated in FIG. 1, the information processing system **1000** according to the first exemplary embodiment includes a situation information receiving unit **110**, a normal situation storage unit **210**, a retrieval unit **120**, and an output unit **130**. The information processing system **1000** is operated by an operator of a monitoring system, for example.

[0033] The situation information receiving unit **110** receives an input of situation information. The situation information is information indicating a situation in a monitoring target environment. For example, the situation information is information indicating an action by a person and the like in the monitoring target environment. The situation information may be information indicating a motion of a bicycle, a motorcycle, a car, and the like driven by a person in the monitoring target environment, for example. The situation information may be information indicating a number of people per unit area in the monitoring target environment, for example. The situation information may be represented by a co-occurrence expression such as “a person is holding something like a knife, and a person is shouting”, for example.

[0034] The normal situation storage unit **210** stores environment information indicating the environment in association with a set of situation information indicating situations that are not abnormal in the monitoring target environment.

[0035] FIG. 2 is a diagram illustrating an example of information stored by the normal situation storage unit **210**. As illustrated in FIG. 2, the normal situation storage unit **210** stores environment information such as “soccer stadium” in association with a set of situation information such as “a person is screaming loudly”, “a person is jumping”, and “a person is cheering”. At a soccer stadium, the situations such as “a person is screaming loudly”, “a person is jumping”, and “a person is cheering” are the usual situations but not at all abnormal situations.

[0036] In this way, the normal situation storage unit **210** stores the information in which the set of the situation information (“a person is screaming loudly”, “a person is jumping”, and “a person is cheering”) indicating situations that are not abnormal in the monitoring target environment (soccer stadium) is associated with the environment information (soccer stadium) indicating the

environment.

[0037] Going back to FIG. 1, the retrieval unit **120** refers to the normal situation storage unit **210** to retrieve environment information associated with a set of situation information that does not include the situation information received by the situation information receiving unit **110**.

[0038] For example, the situation information receiving unit **110** receives situation information such as “a person is holding something like a knife”. The retrieval unit **120** refers to the normal situation storage unit **210** illustrated in FIG. 2 to retrieve environment information such as “soccer stadium”, “live concert”, and “airport” that are associated with a set of situation information which does not include the situation information such as “a person is holding something like a knife”.

[0039] For example, the situation information receiving unit **110** receives an input of situation information expressed in a co-occurrence expression such as “a person is shouting, and a person is jumping”. The retrieval unit **120** refers to the normal situation storage unit **210** illustrated in FIG. 2 to retrieve environment information that is associated with a set of situation information which includes neither the situation information such as “a person is shouting” nor the situation information such as “a person is jumping”. That is, the retrieval unit **120** retrieves the environment information such as “airport” and “kitchen”.

[0040] The output unit **130** outputs a list of the retrieved environment information.

[0041] FIG. 3 is a diagram of a hardware configuration of the information processing system **1000** illustrated in FIG. 1. As illustrated in FIG. 3, the information processing system **1000** includes a Central Processing Unit (CPU) **10**, a storage device **20**, and a communication interface **30**. The information processing system **1000** may include an input device **40** and an output device **50**.

[0042] Functions of the information processing system **1000** are realized by the CPU **10** that executes a program read to the storage device **20**, for example. The communication performed by the information processing system **1000** is realized by an application program that controls the communication interface **30** by using a function provided by an Operating System (OS), for example. The input device **40** is a keyboard, a mouse, or a touch panel, for example. The output device **50** is a display, for example.

[0043] Note that the present invention exemplified by this exemplary embodiment and subsequent respective exemplary embodiments may be configured by a non-volatile storage medium **70** such as a compact disc and the like in which the program described above is stored. The program stored in the storage medium **70** is read by a drive device **60**, for example.

[0044] The information processing system **1000** may be configured such that two or more physically separated devices are connected by wire or wirelessly.

[0045] Next, an operation of the information processing system **1000** illustrated in FIG. 1 will be described by using FIG. 4. FIG. 4 is a flowchart illustrating an example of the operation of the information processing system **1000**.

[0046] The situation information receiving unit **110** receives an input of situation information (**S101**). The retrieval unit **120** refers to the normal situation storage unit **210** and retrieves the environment information associated with the set of the situation information that does not include the situation information of which input is received (**S102**). The output unit **130** outputs the environment information retrieved by the retrieval unit **120** (**S103**).

[0047] The effect taken by the information processing system **1000** according to the first exemplary embodiment will be described.

[0048] By confirming the information output by the output unit **130**, the operator is able to recognize that the situation information received by the situation information receiving unit **110** is appropriate as the information to be described in a conditional clause of a monitoring rule for monitoring the environment indicated by the environment information output by the output unit **130**. For example, the operator is able to recognize that the situation information such as “a person is holding something like a knife” is appropriate for the information to be described in the conditional clause of the monitoring rule for monitoring “soccer stadium”, “live concert”, and

“airport”.

[0049] It is assumed that the monitoring rule is expanded in order to reduce man-hour of the operator in setting the monitoring rule for a plurality of environments. The information processing system **1000** according to the first exemplary embodiment is able to output a list of the monitoring target environments that can be expanded for the situation information of which input is received. Therefore, when expanding the monitoring rule, the operator is not required to confirm, one by one, whether or not the monitoring rule is expandable. This allows for a reduction of man-hour of the operator in setting the monitoring rule to a plurality of environments to be monitored.

[0050] As described above, the information processing system **1000** according to the first exemplary embodiment can support the operator to set a monitoring rule in response to a monitoring target environment.

[0051] Note that the output unit **130** may output information in which the retrieved environment information is associated with the situation information of which input is received. Further, the output unit **130** may additionally output information indicating that the situation indicated by the situation information of which input is received is the abnormal situation in the environment indicated by the output environment information. Such a configuration allows the information processing system **1000** to indicate more comprehensible information to the operator. That is, the information processing system **1000** can indicate more directly to the operator that the environmental information output by the situation information of which input is received is appropriate for the information to be described in the conditional clause of the monitoring rule.

[0052] Note that the information to be stored by the normal situation storage unit **210** may be generated manually or may be generated by the information processing system **1000**. When manually generating the information to be stored in the normal situation storage unit **210**, the operator generates information in which usual actions or expressions under usual situations at a place or an event to be monitored are associated with the place or the event. It is assumed that the information processing system **1000** generates the information stored in the normal situation storage unit **210**. In this case, the information processing system **1000** may generate the information to be stored in the normal situation storage unit **210** by extracting the situation information from texts such as blogs written about the place or the event to be monitored. This is because illegal acts, manner breach acts, and the like are less likely to be written in blogs and the like.

[0053] When the information processing system **1000** arranges the information stored in the normal situation storage unit **210**, a technique for extracting a compound word of high appearance frequency may be utilized, as disclosed in Reference 1, for example.

Reference 1

[0054] “Synonym Extraction Using Web Search Query and Click-through Logs” by Kei Uchiumi and Mamoru Komachi, Transactions of Information Processing Society of Japan, Database, Vol. 6 (No. 1), Pages 16-28, Published on Jan. 23, 2013

[0055] The information processing system **1000** according to the first exemplary embodiment outputs a list of the environments to be monitored that can be expanded relative to the situation information of which input is received. However, the information processing system **1000** may output a list of the environments to be monitored which cannot be expanded relative to the situation information of which input is received.

[0056] Note that the environment information is not limited to the information indicating a place, an event, a time slot, or the like. For example, information such as “environment with little traffic”, “environment whose temperature is 25 degrees centigrade or higher and humidity is 80% or higher”, and so on can be the environment information. The environment information may include actions by a person. For example, information such as “in the environment with a women having a bag”, “in the environment where a silver car stops”, “when a child is checking the left and right”, and so on can be the environment information.

[0057] The situation information may be an action taken by a person in the environment to be monitored. In this case, the situation information can be rephrased by action information. The situation information receiving unit **110** receives an input of action information indicating an action by a person taken in the monitoring target environment. The normal situation storage unit **210** stores the environment information indicating the environment in association with a set of action information indicating actions that are not abnormal in the monitoring target environment. The retrieval unit **120** refers to the normal situation storage unit **210** and retrieves the environment information associated with the set of the action information that does not include the action information of which input is received.

Second Exemplary Embodiment

[0058] FIG. **5** is a block diagram illustrating a configuration of an information processing system **2000** according to a second exemplary embodiment. The same reference numerals are provided to substantially the same components as those illustrated in FIG. **1**. As illustrated in FIG. **5**, the information processing system **2000** according to the second exemplary embodiment includes a second situation information receiving unit **140** and a situation information extracting unit **150** in addition to the information processing system **1000** according to the first exemplary embodiment.

[0059] The second situation information receiving unit **140** receives an input of information including situation information. The information including the situation information may be text data representing natural sentence, or may be image data, audio data, or video data, for example.

[0060] The situation information extracting unit **150** extracts the situation information from the information including the situation information. For example, it is assumed that the second situation information receiving unit **140** receives an input of the following text. “A fifth grade boy student of this school found an adult holding something like a knife and shouting in a strange voice within 70 to 80 m behind him on the way home after playing at a park. Because he thought he might be attacked, he rushed home by bicycle and reported it.” The situation information extracting unit **150** extracts the expressions representing the situation of the monitoring target environment such as “an adult is holding something like a knife” and “an adult is shouting in a strange voice” from the above text. The situation information extracting unit **150** may extract a co-occurrence expression such as “an adult is holding something like a knife, and the adult is shouting in a strange voice”. The situation information extracting unit **150** may extract a human action in the monitoring target environment preferentially, for example.

[0061] The situation information extracting unit **150** may determine the entity of the action to utilize it for the extraction by using a method disclosed in Reference 2, for example.

Reference 2

[0062] “Morpheme, Construction, and Case Analysis Using JUMAN/KNP”, by Daisuke Kawahara, Sadao Kurohashi, Academic Center for Computing and Media Studies, Kyoto University, Media Information Processing Specialized Course, “Natural Language Processing Technique”, held on Sep. 8 to Sep. 10, 2008

[0063] Next, an operation of the information processing system **2000** illustrated in FIG. **5** will be described by using FIG. **6**. FIG. **6** is a flowchart illustrating the operation of the information processing system **2000**. The same reference numerals are provided to substantially the same operations as those illustrated in the flowchart of FIG. **4**.

[0064] The second situation information receiving unit **140** receives an input of information including situation information (**S201**). The situation information extracting unit **150** extracts the situation information from the information including the situation information (**S202**). The situation information extracting unit **150** outputs the extracted situation information to the situation information receiving unit **110** (**S203**). Since the subsequent operations are the same as those by the information processing system **1000** according to the first exemplary embodiment, description thereof will be omitted.

[0065] The information processing system **2000** according to the second exemplary embodiment

can support setting of a monitoring rule in response to a monitoring target environment.

Third Exemplary Embodiment

[0066] FIG. 7 is a block diagram illustrating a configuration of an information processing system **3000** according to a third exemplary embodiment. The same reference numerals are provided to substantially the same components as those illustrated in FIG. 1. As illustrated in FIG. 7, the information processing system **3000** according to the third exemplary embodiment includes an expression expansion unit **160** and a synonym storage unit **220** in addition to the information processing system **1000** according to the first exemplary embodiment.

[0067] In the synonym storage unit **220**, different situation information indicating the same or a similar situation is associated and stored for respective situation information. For example, situation information such as “a person is shouting loudly”, “a person is shrieking”, and “a crowd is screaming loudly” is associated with the situation information such as “a person is shouting loudly” and stored.

[0068] The expression expansion unit **160** extracts, from the synonym storage unit **220**, a synonym(s) for the situation information received by a situation information receiving unit **110**.

[0069] Next, an operation of the information processing system **3000** illustrated in FIG. 7 will be described by using FIG. 8. FIG. 8 is a flowchart illustrating the operation of the information processing system **3000**. The same reference numerals are provided to substantially the same operations as those illustrated in the flowchart of FIG. 4.

[0070] The situation information receiving unit **110** receives an input of situation information (**S101**). The expression expansion unit **160** extracts, from the synonym storage unit **220**, a synonym(s) for the situation information received by the situation information receiving unit **110** (**S301**). The retrieval unit **120** retrieves environment information associated with a set of situation information that includes neither the situation information received by the situation information receiving unit **110** nor the synonym extracted by the expression expansion unit **160** (**S302**). The output unit **130** outputs the environment information retrieved by the retrieval unit **120** (**S103**).

[0071] The information processing system **3000** according to the third exemplary embodiment can utilize the synonym extracted by the expression expansion unit **160** in addition to the situation information received by the situation information receiving unit **110**. Therefore, setting of a monitoring rule in response to a monitoring target environment can be supported with higher accuracy.

Fourth Exemplary Embodiment

[0072] FIG. 9 is a block diagram illustrating a configuration of an information processing system **4000** according to a fourth exemplary embodiment. As illustrated in FIG. 9, the information processing system **4000** according to the fourth exemplary embodiment includes a third situation information receiving unit **170**, a verification unit **180**, and a verified result output unit **190**.

[0073] The third situation information receiving unit **170** receives an input of information in which situation information is associated with environment information. The operator inputs the information in which situation information is associated with environment information. The situation information is intended to be described as a conditional clause of a monitoring rule for monitoring an environment indicated by that environment information.

[0074] For example, it is assumed that the operator considers describing the situation information such as “a person is screaming loudly” or “a person is holding something like a knife” as a conditional clause of a monitoring rule for monitoring a kitchen. In this case, the operator inputs, to the third situation information receiving unit **170**, information in which the environment information as “kitchen” is associated with the situation information as “a person is screaming loudly” (hereafter referred to as first information). Further, the operator inputs, to the third situation information receiving unit **170**, information in which the environment information as “kitchen” is associated with the situation information as “a person is holding something like a knife” (hereafter referred to as second information).

[0075] The verification unit **180** refers to a normal situation storage unit **210** and compares a set of the situation information associated with the environment information included in the information of which input is received with the situation information included in the information of which input is received. The verification unit **180** then verifies whether or not there is matched situation information.

[0076] In the example of the first information described above, the verification unit **180** refers to the normal situation storage unit **210** illustrated in FIG. 2. The verification unit **180** compares the set of the situation information (a person is holding something like a knife) associated with the environment information (kitchen) included in the first information with the situation information (a person is screaming loudly) included in the first information. The verification unit **180** verifies whether or not there is matched situation information. In the example of the first information, there is no matched situation information.

[0077] In the example of the second information described above, the verification unit **180** refers to the normal situation storage unit **210** illustrated in FIG. 2. The verification unit **180** compares the set of the situation information (a person is holding something like a knife) associated with the environment information (kitchen) included in the first information with the situation information (a person is holding something like a knife) included in the first information. The verification unit **180** verifies whether or not there is matched situation information. In the example of the second information, there is matched situation information such as “a person is holding something like a knife”.

[0078] The verified result output unit **190** outputs a result of the verification performed by the verification unit **180**.

[0079] Next, an operation of the information processing system **4000** illustrated in FIG. 9 will be described by using FIG. 10. FIG. 10 is a flowchart illustrating the operation of the information processing system **4000**.

[0080] The third situation information receiving unit **170** receives an input of the information in which the situation information is associated with the environment information (**S401**). The verification unit **180** refers to the normal situation storage unit **210** to compare the set of the situation information associated with the environment information included in the information of which input is received with the situation information included in the information of which input is received. The verification unit **180** verifies whether or not there is situation information matched each other (**S402**). The verified result output unit **190** outputs the environment information retrieved by the verification unit **180** (**S403**).

[0081] The effect taken by the information processing system **4000** according to the fourth exemplary embodiment will be described.

[0082] The information processing system **4000** according to the fourth exemplary embodiment can determine whether or not the situation indicated by the situation information of which input is received is an abnormal situation in the environment indicated by the environment information of which input is received.

[0083] The operator can verify whether or not the monitoring rule that the operator intends to set is appropriate for monitoring a monitoring target environment by confirming the verified result output by the verified result output unit **190**.

[0084] In the example described above, the operator can notice that it is inappropriate to describe the situation information such as “holding something like a knife” as the conditional clause of the monitoring rule for monitoring the kitchen.

[0085] In this way, the information processing system **4000** according to the fourth exemplary embodiment can support to verify as to whether or not a monitoring rule is appropriate.

[0086] While some aspects have been described hererinabove for implementing the present invention, the exemplary embodiments described above are intended to facilitate the understanding of the present invention and not intended to limit the present invention in its interpretation. The

present invention may be modified and improved without departing from its spirits, and the equivalents thereof are included in the present invention.

[0087] The present application claims priority to Japanese Patent Application No. 2013-090536 filed on Apr. 23, 2013, and the entire disclosure of which is incorporated herein.

INDUSTRIAL APPLICABILITY

[0088] According to the present invention, setting or verification of a monitoring rule in response to a monitoring target environment can be supported.

REFERENCE SIGNS LIST

[0089] **10** CPU [0090] **20** storage device [0091] **30** communication interface [0092] **40** input device [0093] **50** output device [0094] **60** drive device [0095] **70** storage medium [0096] **110** situation information receiving unit [0097] **120** retrieval unit [0098] **130** output unit [0099] **140** second situation information receiving unit [0100] **150** situation information extracting unit [0101] **160** expression expansion unit [0102] **170** third situation information receiving unit [0103] **180** verification unit [0104] **190** verified result output unit [0105] **210** normal situation storage unit [0106] **220** synonym storage unit [0107] **1000** information processing system [0108] **2000** information processing system [0109] **3000** information processing system [0110] **4000** information processing system

Claims

1. (canceled)
2. An information processing method implemented by one or more processors, the information processing method comprising: acquiring rule information including a first rule of a first object associated with a first place and a second rule of a second object associated with a second place, the first rule and the second rule set by a user; receiving input information including a state of an object associated with a third place based on image data; determining whether the input information is associated with a monitoring target based on the rule information and the input information; and controlling to output information indicating that the input information is associated with the monitoring target based on the determining indicating the input information is associated with the monitoring target.
3. The information processing method of claim 2, wherein the first rule is related to a first action of the first object occurring at the first place, and wherein the second rule is related to a second action of the second object occurring at the second place.
4. The information processing method of claim 2, wherein the first rule includes first time information, the second rule includes second time information, and the input information includes third time information.
5. The information processing method of claim 2, wherein the determining includes determining whether the input information is the monitoring target based on a third rule associated with the third place being included in the input information.
6. The information processing method of claim 2, wherein the rule information comprises a plurality of monitoring rules, and the plurality of monitoring rules are configured with condition clauses.
7. An information processing device comprising: one or more memories storing a set of instructions; and one or more processors configured to execute the set of instructions to: acquire rule information including a first rule of a first object associated with a first place and a second rule of a second object associated with a second place, the first rule and the second rule set by a user; receive input information including a state of an object associated with a third place based on image data; determine whether the input information is associated with a monitoring target based on the rule information and the input information; and control to output information indicating that the input information is associated with the monitoring target based on determining the input

information is associated with the monitoring target.

8. The information processing device of claim 7, wherein the first rule is related to a first action of the first object occurring at the first place, and wherein the second rule is related to a second action of the second object occurring at the second place.

9. The information processing device of claim 7, wherein the first rule includes first time information, the second rule includes second time information, and the input information includes third time information.

10. The information processing device of claim 7, wherein the one or more processors are further configured to execute the set of instructions to determine whether the input information is the monitoring target based on a third rule associated with the third place being included in the input information.

11. The information processing device of claim 7, wherein the rule information comprises a plurality of monitoring rules, and the plurality of monitoring rules are configured with condition clauses.

12. A non-transitory computer readable storage medium causing a computer to execute processing of: acquiring rule information including a first rule of a first object associated with a first place and a second rule of a second object associated with a second place, the first rule and the second rule set by a user; receiving input information including a state of an object associated with a third place based on image data; determining whether the input information is associated with a monitoring target based on the rule information and the input information; and controlling to output information indicating that the input information is associated with the monitoring target based on determining the input information is associated with the monitoring target.

13. The non-transitory computer readable storage medium of claim 12, wherein the first rule is related to a first action of the first object occurring at the first place, and wherein the second rule is related to a second action of the second object occurring at the second place.

14. The non-transitory computer readable storage medium of claim 12, wherein the first rule includes first time information, the second rule includes second time information, and the input information includes third time information.

15. The non-transitory computer readable storage medium of claim 12, wherein the determining includes determining whether the input information is the monitoring target based on a third rule associated with the third place being included in the input information.

16. The non-transitory computer readable storage medium of claim 12, wherein the rule information comprises a plurality of monitoring rules, and the plurality of monitoring rules are configured with condition clauses.
